

ENVISION GREATNESS · BRITTANY CLAUSEN

THE EQ EDGE

Self-Assessment Guide

Discover exactly where emotional intelligence is costing you
— in your leadership, your relationships, and your results.

Grounded in the Empathy Bridge Framework (EBF)

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You Don't Have a Strategy Problem.

Let's be honest about why you're here.

You've put in the work. The degrees, the promotions, the business — maybe even the speaking gigs and the thought leadership content. And still, somewhere in the back of your mind, there's this quiet, persistent question: *Why does this still feel so hard?*

You avoid certain conversations because you know they'll spiral. You say yes when you mean no — and then resent the people you said yes to. You replay meetings in your head at 2am, editing your words, second-guessing your reactions. You watch less-qualified people rise faster and wonder what they know that you don't.

Here's what's actually happening: **the gap isn't your strategy. It's your emotional intelligence.**

"EQ is not about being soft. It's about being precise. Knowing what's driving your behavior — so you can choose your response instead of being hijacked by it."

About the Empathy Bridge Framework (EBF)

This assessment is grounded in the **Empathy Bridge Framework** — a diagnostic model developed by Brittany Clausen through years of working with leaders, teams, and organizations in conflict. EBF identifies three layers where emotional intelligence breaks down:

EMOTIONAL	How you relate to yourself. Self-awareness, self-regulation, your patterns under stress. What happens in you before it happens around you.
RELATIONAL	How you relate to others. Empathy, communication style, conflict patterns, and whether people feel safe enough to tell you the truth.
ORGANIZATIONAL	How you show up in systems. The culture you're building — intentionally or not. Whether your team's emotional environment is an asset or a liability.

How to Use This Assessment

Each section has **5 questions**. Rate yourself honestly on a scale of **1–5**:

1 = Never 2 = Rarely 3 = Sometimes 4 = Often 5 = Almost Always

No one is watching. No one is grading you. The only person this helps is you — but only if you answer what's actually true, not what sounds good.

Emotional Intelligence

This is where everything starts. Before you can lead anyone else well, you have to understand what's happening inside you — especially when the pressure is on.

Q1

When you're stressed or overwhelmed at work, do you notice it in your body before you react?

Think: jaw tension, chest tightening, voice going flat. Your body signals stress before your brain does.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q2

How often do you say 'I'm fine' — at work or to yourself — when you're clearly not?

This is the emotional suppression pattern. High-achievers are especially good at this one.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q3

After a difficult meeting or conversation, do you replay it for hours — editing, rehearsing, second-guessing?

This is called rumination. It's exhausting, and it signals unprocessed emotional charge.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q4

When you receive critical feedback, can you sit with it — or do you immediately start building a defense?

Self-regulation under ego threat. This is one of the highest-leverage EQ skills in leadership.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q5

Can you name the top 3 situations or behaviors that reliably trigger a strong emotional reaction in you at work?

If you can't name them, you can't manage them. Triggers unnamed are triggers in charge.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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DOMAIN SCORE /25

Add your ratings: ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ = _____

Relational Intelligence

Leadership is relational. The question isn't just how smart you are — it's whether people feel safe enough to be honest with you, and whether you can actually hear them when they are.

Q1

When conflict comes up with a colleague or direct report, is your first instinct toward it — or away from it?

Conflict avoidance is one of the most common EQ gaps in high-functioning leaders. Avoidance compounds everything.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q2

Do the people closest to you at work feel like they can tell you hard things — without managing your reaction first?

This is psychological safety at the interpersonal level. If people pre-edit around you, you're leading with fear.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q3

When someone on your team is visibly struggling, is your first move to create space — or to solve it for them because it's faster?

Over-functioning as a leader kills people's agency and signals that you don't trust them to figure things out.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q4

In disagreements, are you more focused on being right — or on being understood (and understanding)?

The need to win arguments is one of the clearest signs that ego is driving, not leadership.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q5

Are you aware of how differently you show up in high-stakes conversations versus low-pressure ones?

This gap — the difference between your 'best self' and your 'under fire' self — is exactly what EQ training closes.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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DOMAIN SCORE /25

Add your ratings: ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ = _____

Organizational Intelligence

Your EQ doesn't just affect you — it builds or erodes the culture around you. This section looks at how your patterns are showing up in your team, your systems, and the emotional environment you're creating whether you mean to or not.

Q1

Does your team have genuine psychological safety — meaning they can disagree with you, flag problems, and take risks without fear?

Not 'do you think they feel safe' — do they actually act like it? There's usually a gap here.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q2

Do you unconsciously favor and promote people who communicate and lead like you — and undervalue those who don't?

This is affinity bias. It's one of the most common ways leaders accidentally build monocultures.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q3

Does your team's conflict pattern lean toward: avoiding it, exploding with it, or engaging it directly?

Teams take on the conflict pattern of their leader. Your answer here reflects more than just your team.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q4

Do you know the emotional temperature of your team right now — not their performance numbers, their actual emotional state?

Most leaders track KPIs. Almost none can answer this question accurately. That gap has a cost.

1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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Q5

When something goes wrong organizationally, is your first instinct to find the systemic cause — or the individual to hold accountable?

Systems thinking vs. blame culture. Where your attention goes when things break tells you a lot about how you lead.

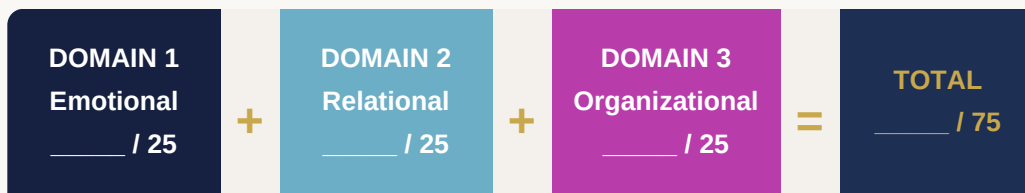
1 Never	2 Rarely	3 Sometimes	4 Often	5 Always
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DOMAIN SCORE /25

Add your ratings: ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ = _____

What Your Score Actually Means

Add up your scores across all three domains. Maximum total: **75 points**.



Score Ranges

Foundations Stage · Score: 15 – 34

Your self-awareness is just beginning to surface — and that's not a criticism, it's a starting point. Most high-achievers have spent years optimizing their external performance at the expense of their internal world. The awareness you're building now is the most important shift you'll ever make.

Emerging Awareness · Score: 35 – 49

You have genuine self-awareness — you can see your patterns, even if you can't always interrupt them in real time. The work here is consistency: closing the gap between who you are on your good days and who you are when the pressure is highest.

Practicing EQ · Score: 50 – 62

You're doing the inner work and it shows. Your emotional intelligence is active — but there are still specific triggers, relationships, or environments that reveal the edge. Targeted practice in your weakest domain will create a disproportionate return.

Leading with EQ · Score: 63 – 75

You're operating at a high level of emotional intelligence. The question now isn't whether you have EQ — it's whether your environment, your team, and your systems reflect it. The next frontier is scaling your inner work into organizational culture.

Important: Your score is a starting point, not a verdict. EQ is not fixed — it is the most learnable, most changeable dimension of human performance. The leaders who grow the fastest are the ones who stop treating their emotional patterns as personality and start treating them as *skills to be developed*.

What to Focus On Next

Look at your three domain scores individually. The lowest score is your highest-leverage starting point — not because it's your 'worst' area, but because growth there will ripple into everything else.

If Emotional was your lowest score:

Your nervous system is running the show — and it doesn't know the difference between a 'threatening' performance review and an actual threat. The psychological concept at play is **amygdala hijack** (Goleman, 1995): when we're triggered, the emotional brain overrides the reasoning brain before we're even aware it happened.

Start here: **daily body check-ins** (3x/day — morning, midday, end of day). Not journaling, not meditating — just 60 seconds of noticing where you're holding tension and naming the feeling driving it. What you name, you can regulate. What you don't name, you act out.

If Relational was your lowest score:

Your relationships are likely functional — but are they honest? The psychological principle here is **psychological safety** (Amy Edmondson, Harvard): teams perform significantly better when members feel safe to speak up, take risks, and be wrong without punishment.

Start here: **ask one brave question this week** — to someone on your team or in your orbit: *'What's something you haven't told me that you think I should know?'* Then listen without defending, explaining, or pivoting. Just receive it.

If Organizational was your lowest score:

The culture you're building is a mirror of your inner world — amplified. The research is clear (**Gallup, McKinsey, Edmondson**): the #1 predictor of team performance isn't talent or process. It's whether people feel emotionally safe enough to do their best work.

Start here: **audit your reactions** — for one week, notice how you respond when someone brings you a problem, a mistake, or a disagreement. What's the emotional environment you're modeling in those moments? Your team is watching, and they're calibrating their behavior accordingly.

Self-awareness is the beginning. Not the destination.

This assessment is designed to show you where the work is — not make you feel bad about it. Every leader has gaps. The ones who close them are the ones who stop pretending the gaps don't exist.

The **Empathy Bridge Framework** doesn't just diagnose — it gives you a path. Whether you're navigating conflict on your team, trying to break a leadership pattern that keeps costing you, or building a culture that can actually hold under pressure — this is the work.

Ready to Close the Gap?

Book a keynote, workshop, or strategy session with Brittany — or explore the full suite of EQ and leadership resources at Envision Greatness.

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Also available: the **EQ Edge Newsletter** — weekly insight on emotional intelligence, leadership, and the inner work that actually moves the needle. Subscribe at brittanyclausen.com

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